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What is a Visual Abstract?



JMIR Marketing Department

4 months ago · Updated

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A Visual Abstract is a brief summary of the key findings of an article, presented in a graphical format for easy uptake by readers. It gives the reader a quick overview of the main study findings at a glance, and helps them decide whether the paper is relevant to their interests. Such a representation of the study also allows for better dissemination of the article to a broad audience.

View the full [Visual Abstract Gallery](#).

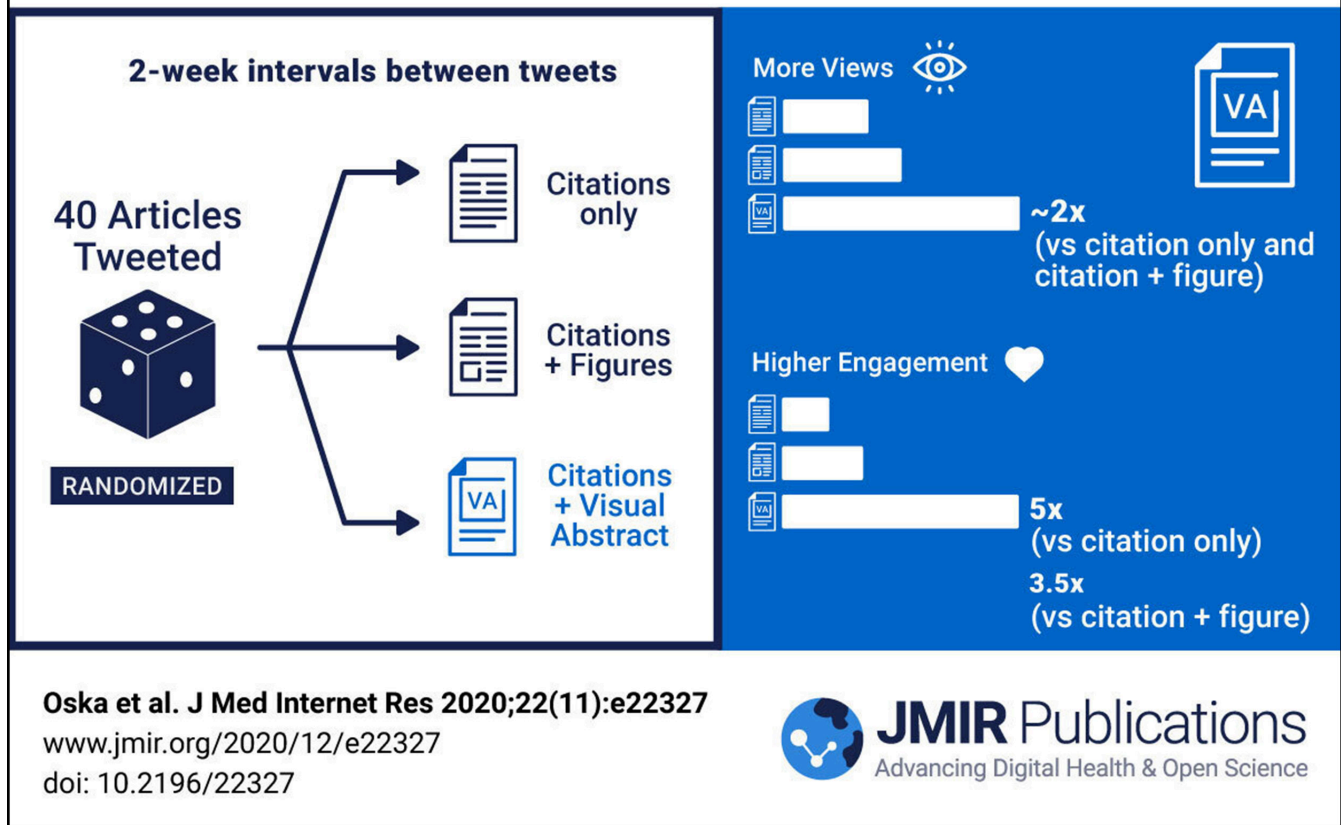
How does it work?

JMIR authors can choose to have a Visual Abstract created by a JMIR Publications in-house designer.

The Visual Abstract will be tweeted together with the paper (instead of the traditional non-text [TOC image](#)), will show up in the Table of Contents (TOC), and will be embedded in the paper.

As all our [knowledge translation tools](#), this is an evidence-based strategy that has been shown to enhance the impact of a publication, as shown in a recent RCT:

A Picture Is Worth a Thousand Views: A Triple Crossover Trial of Visual Abstracts to Examine Their Impact on Research Dissemination



View this visual abstract on [the journal page](#) and on [Twitter](#).

How can I opt in for this service?

This KT tool can be ordered when you check out and pay the APF for your article (see [How can I order/pay for knowledge dissemination add-ons like TrendMD or sponsored Tweets?](#))

We recommend combining this option with our sponsored tweet service to further enhance dissemination.

Once you opt for our Visual Abstract service, we will reach out to you to understand the key messages you would like us to convey in the visual abstract, so that our designers can help bring your ideas and vision to fruition.

Examples of visual abstracts published in JMIR Publications:

Evaluation of the HeartHealth Text Messaging Program for Patients With Cardiovascular Disease

The HeartHealth program

Patients with cardiovascular disease often need ongoing lifestyle and medication support after clinic visits or hospital discharge



A structured 6-month text messaging program to provide education, reminders, and behavioral support



8804 adult patients over 4 years:

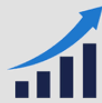


• Attended cardiology clinics or



• Discharged after cardiology hospitalization

Mixed methods study



Analysis of program data (enrollment, retention, and engagement)



Participant feedback surveys



Staff focus-group discussions

Survey responses



60.5% improved diet quality



53.6% increased physical activity



56.1% improved medication adherence

Participant feedback



Prompted dietary change



Provided emotional support



Reinforced behavior change



Improved focus



Improved confidence in managing health

Key barriers



Limited personalization



Language options



SMS scheduling flexibility

Recommended adaptations



Enhance personalization



Improve engagement by local clinical teams



Expand program dissemination

Summary: The HeartHealth program had a broad reach, improved patient-reported health behaviors, and provided needed support to participants at a low cost with limited resources.

Sheahen B, Laranjo L, Trivedi R, et al. The HeartHealth Program: A Mixed Methods Study of a Community-Based Text Messaging Support Program for Patients With Cardiovascular Disease From 2020 to 2024
JMIR Cardio 2026;10:e68896
URL: <https://cardio.jmir.org/2026/1/e68896>
DOI: 10.2196/68896



JMIR Publications
Advancing Digital Health & Open Science

View this visual abstract on [the journal page](#).

Does Retrieval-Augmented Generation Improve Emergency Department Triage Accuracy?

Background



Emergency departments (EDs) require rapid and accurate **triage** to prioritize high-risk patients



Large language models (LLMs) can support triage decisions but may generate unsafe recommendations due to hallucinations



Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) may improve reliability by integrating guideline- and case-based evidence

Retrospective single-center study



Multi-Evidence Clinical Reasoning RAG (MECCR-RAG), a dual-source RAG system

- Hong Kong Accident and Emergency Triage Guidelines
- 3000 ED triage cases



VS
Prompt-only baseline LLM



- Tested on **236 ED triage encounters** randomly sampled across 2023
- Prediction of **5-level triage categories**



Outcomes

- **Triage accuracy**
- **Agreement** with expert nurse consensus
- Outcome-based **severity level** and **safety**

Key findings for MECCR-RAG



Higher expert agreement and exact-match accuracy than the baseline LLM



Reduced overtriage while maintaining **low undertriage**



Lower severity-weighted harm index compared to nurses and the baseline LLM



The **DeepSeek-V3-based MECCR-RAG pipeline** generalized to Claude and ChatGPT in an exploratory run

Summary: MECCR-RAG achieved expert-comparable ED triage agreement by grounding LLM reasoning in local guidelines and past cases, supporting prospective multicenter decision-support validation.

Wong HS, Wong TK. Multi-Evidence Clinical Reasoning With Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Emergency Triage: Retrospective Evaluation Study
JMIR Med Inform 2026;14:e82026
URL: <https://medinform.jmir.org/2026/1/e82026>
DOI: 10.2196/82026



JMIR Publications
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Neglect Radio: A Smartphone Spatial-Audio Training App for Hemispatial Neglect



Hemispatial neglect is an **attentional disorder** affecting roughly **one-third** of patients after **acute stroke**



It is associated with **poor recovery** and is a major challenge in **neurorehabilitation**



The **Neglect Radio** app delivers **auditory motion stimulation**, which combines music therapy with spatial cues, to enhance spatial awareness and reduce neglect symptoms

Spatial realism test



37 healthy adults



Listened to 5 audio samples in 3 motion conditions

- Static stereo
- Dynamic stereo volume control
- Head-related transfer function (HRTF)-based rendering



Rated spatial realism from 0 to 100

Usability test



10 healthy adults



Used the app for 15 minutes



Completed the System Usability Scale (SUS)

Findings



HRTF-based rendering was significantly **more realistic** than volume control



Static stereo was the **least realistic**



Usability was excellent (86.5), exceeding the 68-point threshold for above-average usability

Summary:

A smartphone app using realistic spatial audio shows excellent usability and may support future rehabilitation for hemispatial neglect.

Nef T, Geiser N, Kaufmann BC, et al. Smartphone-Based Auditory Motion Stimulation for Hemispatial Neglect: Development and Usability Study
J Med Internet Res 2025;27:e82442
URL: <https://www.jmir.org/2025/1/e82442>
DOI: 10.2196/82442



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